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At a glance: Assembly members finish with comfortable leads despite challenges in races across L.A. County

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More than a dozen lawmakers across Los Angeles County who were running to hold onto their Assembly districts in Tuesday's primary found themselves in strong positions as they head into November's general election.

Sitting members faced challengers in 16 of the 24 Assembly elections on the county ballot. The top two candidates in each of Tuesday's primary races will advance to the general election in November.

With 100 percent of the precincts reporting, unofficial results showed that in nearly all of contested races, incumbents held comfortable leads for districts throughout the Los Angeles region, including in the San Fernando, Santa Clarita and San Gabriel valleys.

Only Cristina Garcia, who was accused of sexual harassment earlier this year, appeared to show some weakness. She is advancing to the general election, but garnered only a slim lead ahead of Republican challenger, Mike Simpfenderfer.

Meanwhile, the field was decisively narrowed for two additional seats that are up for grabs in the San Fernando Valley, where lawmakers Raul Bocanegra and Matt Dababneh recently stepped down following allegations of sexual harassment.

For the northeast San Fernando Valley seat once held by Bocanegra, Democrat Luz Rivas and Republican Ricardo Antonio Benitez advanced to the general elections for an open seat that until December was held by Bocanegra. Rivas won a separate special election, also held Tuesday, to complete Bocanegra's unfinished term.

And Democrat Jesse Gabriel, an attorney, and Justin Clark, a Republican, will continue on to fight for the west San Fernando Valley seat once held by Dababneh in the general election. Gabriel also prevailed in the special election, held Tuesday, to complete Dababneh's current unfinished term.

In the race for a third open seat, Democrat Sydney K. Kamlager held a strong lead ahead of five other candidates vying to represent the 54th District covering West Los Angeles, Culver City and other communities. The area was formerly represented by Sebastian Ridley-Thomas, who recently resigned due to health reasons. Kamlager is already representing this district, after getting elected in April to complete Ridley-Thomas's unfinished term. In the race for the upcoming term, the unofficial results has Kamlager facing off against educator and scientist Tepring Piquado, a Democrat, in the general election. Another candidate, Republican Glen Ratcliff, came in third, not far behind Piquado.

Assembly members from five districts ran unopposed, and will be able to keep their seats for another term. They are the 64th District's Mike Gipson, of Carson; the 50th District's Richard Bloom, of Santa Monica; the 51st District's Wendy Carrillo, of Fullerton; the 48th District's Blanca E. Rubio, of Baldwin Park and the 43rd District's Laura Friedman, of Glendale.

Here is a round-up of how the unofficial results sorted out in the contested and open races:

36th District: Republican Assemblyman Tom Lackey of Lancaster held comfortably onto a frontrunner position against Democratic challenger, Steve Fox, an attorney from Palmdale who held the office before him, as both advanced to the general election.

38th District: Republican Assemblyman Dante Acosta of Santa Clarita will advance to the general election with Newhall School District Board Member Christy Smith, a Democrat from Valencia who had come close to unseating him in 2016.

39th District: Democrat Luz Rivas and second place finisher Republican Ricardo Antonio Benitez beat out four other candidates to advance to the general elections for an open seat representing the northeast San Fernando Valley. The two were also pitted against each other in a run-off election Tuesday to determine who will complete Bocanegra's unfinished term for the same seat, with Rivas winning that race.

41st District: Democratic Assemblyman Chris Holden of Los Angeles held an overwhelming lead against challenger Alan S. Reynolds, a development engineer from South Pasadena who did not pick a party preference, as both head to the general election.

44th District: Democratic Assemblywoman Jacqui Irwin of Camarillo defended her seat against strong results from Republican Ronda Baldwin-Kennedy, an attorney. A third candidate who garnered only a tiny fraction of the votes, so the two are headed to the general election.

45th District: Democrat Jesse Gabriel, an attorney, and second place finisher Justin Clark, a Republican, were atop a field of seven candidates looking to claim an open seat in the west San Fernando Valley that recently also became vacant after Matt Dababneh stepped down in the wake of sexual harassment allegations. Gabriel beat out Clark in a concurrent run-off election to complete Dababneh's unfinished term.

46th District: Democratic Assemblyman Adrin Nazarian of Studio City was well ahead of his challenger, Roxanne Beckford Hoge, a Republican from Valley Village, in the unofficial results, as the pair advanced to the general election.

49th District: Democratic Assemblyman Ed Chau of Arcadia held an overwhelming lead against a challenge from Republican Burton Brink, a retired Sheriff's sergeant from Arcadia, as both advanced to the general election.

52nd District: Democratic Assemblyman Freddie Rodriguez of Pomona finished with a strong lead against his three challengers. The battle for the second spot was led by Toni Holle, a Republican from Chino who is in position to join Rodriguez in advancing to the general election.

53rd District: Democratic Assemblyman Miguel Santiago was well ahead of second place finisher Kevin Hee Young Jang, a fellow Democrat, as the pair advanced to the general election.

54th District: Democrat Sydney K. Kamlager flew ahead of the five other candidates in contention for the open seat left vacant by Ridley-Thomas. Educator and scientist Tepring Piquado, a Democrat, held off Republican Glen Ratcliff to take second place, and will also advance to the general election.

55th District: Republican Assemblyman Phillip Chen, of Diamond Bar, held onto a wide lead over several challengers. Social worker Gregg D. Fritchle, a Democrat from Covina, came in second and will advance to the general election with Chen.

57th District: Democratic Assemblyman Ian C. Calderon commanded the largest share of the votes, with results showing Republican Jessica Martinez of La Habra heading to the general election along with him.

58th District: Seven challengers were looking to unseat Democratic Assemblywoman Cristina Garcia, and unofficial results showed a Republican, Mike Simpfenderfer, leading the pack. Simpfenderfer, who describes himself as a father and victim's advocate, came in with slightly more votes than Garcia in the initial vote-by-mail results but fell back as the rest of votes came in. Pedro Aceituno, a city councilman, was in third place and leading the field of six Democratic challengers, but did not garner enough votes to make it to the general elections. Garcia has faced allegations of sexual harassment, which was found unsubstantiated following an investigation. The accuser is currently appealing the decision.

59th District: Democratic Assemblyman Reggie Jones-Sawyer of Inglewood had an overwhelming over challenger Leslie Hagan-Morgan, a fellow Democrat from Hawthorne, as both advanced to the general election.

62nd District: Democratic Assemblywoman Autumn Burke of Marina Del Rey claimed an overwhelming lead against broker and businessman Al L. Hernandez, a Republican challenger, as both advanced to the general election.

63rd District: Democratic Assemblyman Anthony Rendon took a wide lead ahead of Democrat Maria Estrada, a community advocate and accountant from Beverly Hills who held off Republican Adam Joshua Miller, a documentary producer from Lakewood, to advance to the general elections.

66th District: Democratic Assemblyman Al Muratsuchi of Torrance was followed closely by Republican challenger Frank Scotto, a small business owner from Torrance. The two are head to the general election, despite another challenger.

70th District: Democratic Assemblyman Patrick O'Donnell of Long Beach was having no problem defending his seat. Libertarian Honor "Mimi" Robson, a professional engineer from Long Beach, earned enough votes among the field of three challengers, to make it to the general election.

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